phrase at a time.

I discussed the matter with an Audograph representative and found I could get such a machine within six weeks. What's more, he agreed to let me have a thirty-day trial before requesting me to pay. (I

10 See Nightfall and Other Stories (Doubleday, 1969).

explained there was no way of knowing if I could dictate a story without trying to do so first.)

On November 9, I got my Audograph, dictated a letter, and Gertrude transcribed it. It went very well. On the eleventh, I got to work in earnest and began dictating the first scene of a new story called "Hostess" into the Audograph. In 2V2 weeks, I had it finished and transcribed—12,000 words. What's more, it read just as though I had written it in the usual manner. We were a good team and we were both delighted.

While the story was being written, however, something very frightening took place.

On November 21, 1950, right after the morning rituals of elimination, bathing, and shaving, I was struck with acute abdominal cramps that I recognized at once as being similar to that which hit me in Stuyvesant Town two years before. The difference was that then it lasted for twenty minutes and now it went on and on—and on—

I endured the agony for two hours before breaking down sufficiently to send a frightened Gertrude across the street to fetch a Dr. Adler, whose nameplate we saw in his window. Fortunately he was in and fortunately he ran over.

I thought it was appendicitis, of course, but he asked questions about the location and made the correct diagnosis. I had a kidney stone and what I was suffering from was "renal colic." No doubt I'd had one two years before and passed it. 11

Dr. Adler said that the pain would pass but that I would need X rays to locate the stone. He offered me morphine to ease the pain, but I refused, having an antipathy to addictive drugs. He left and after fifteen minutes more I could not bear the martyrdom and, in an agony of shame, sent Gertrude across the street to ask for the morphine.